Connect

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47845174.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

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Fluff, Romance, College AU, Lesbian Nerds, Seriously they are the biggest nerds, it's adorable, Awkward Adora is Awkward, Adora is a horse girl, These things matter, Glimmer is the most helpful friend ever

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by catrasredemption (dimensionhoppingrose)

Summary

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She stared at the message bubble, torn. Would it be too much to message her immediately after accepting her request? Or would it be weirder if she waited?

The message button lit up with a new notification. Catra tapped it quickly, her heart jumping when she saw Adora's name. Adora had messaged her a single sticker—a unicorn with a rainbow mane saying, "Hi!"

"Oh my god. That's *so* lame."

-OR-

A fluffy Catradora college AU where two nerds learn to communicate.

Notes

This is pure, undiluted fluff, based on this Zelda animation: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BFsOmlvYI

You don't have to know the series to watch the video, it's just a cute college AU with two nerds who don't know how to talk to each other.

There's no point to this story. It just exists and is adorable.

See the end of the work for more notes

The soccer field probably wasn't the *best* place to study. But it was warm, and had the best sun, and Catra just wanted to relax with her flashcard. She was curled up on a bench, shuffling through index cards, preparing for her chemistry exam the next day. People were laughing around her, a soccer ball thudding along the field as it was kicked. The soundtrack was comforting. Catra was warm. It was all very nice.

She was so wrapped up in her studying, she didn't notice when an errant kick sent the ball off the field.

"Watch out!" she heard someone yell. She looked up just in time to see a hand in front of her face, blocking the ball. Catra blinked, surprised, then looked up at the person attached to the hand.

Oh.

It was Adora Gray. She had just transferred to Bright Moon University at the start of the semester, and had immediately become the center of attention. She was definitely everything a person attracted to women could dream of – tall, buff, ocean blue eyes a person could drown in, long, gorgeous blonde hair pulled back in a ponytail.

Okay, *maybe* Catra had a small crush on her too. But she also had some self respect, and refused to join the weird fan club of admirers who followed Adora around.

"Um...hey." Adora laughed, rubbing the back of her head. "You okay?"

"Oh. Yeah, I'm fine. Thanks for that." Catra paused, then stupidly said, "I thought you weren't supposed to touch the ball with your hands."

It was supposed to be witty. It was *decidedly* not. Smooth, Catra.

"Technically I'm not in the game yet," Adora pointed out. "So it doesn't count. Besides, we're allowed to make exceptions if someone is in danger."

"Right. Yeah. Of course."

Smooth. Catra looked away, hoping to hide the blush heating her cheeks. Come on, she wasn't some weird stalker admirer. She could have a normal conversation. Really!

"Adoraaaaaaaa!" Bow called from the field. "You're late!"

Adora jumped, looking at the field, then at Catra. "Guess I better go."

Catra nodded, still staring at the ground. "Thanks for the save."

"Any time." A pause. "Not that I hope you almost get hit with a ball again or anything, I just mean—"

"*Adora*!" This time it was Glimmer, sounding *far* more exasperated. Adora cut herself off abruptly, gave Catra a small wave, and hurried onto the field. Catra dared to look up when she was gone, and found her standing with Bow and Glimmer, who seemed to be teasing her. Her weird fan club had already set up across the field, and were whispering furiously to each other. Absolutely bizarre.

"I can't believe this. A *C minus*? I'm going to kill me."

Adora wasn't *really* listening to Glimmer bemoan her poor test grade. She scanned the quad outside of the building, also not *really* looking for someone. Until she heard a familiar peel of laughter. She stopped, not even noticing when Glimmer walked into her.

There was Catra, sitting on a bench with Entrapta while she watched Scorpia try to ride a skateboard. Adora knew it was Catra's skateboard—the same one she rode everywhere on campus, and

sometimes off campus, if she needed to go to the store. Not that Adora was watching her or anything.

"Earth to Adora." Bow waved a hand in front of Adora's eyes, snapping her back to reality. Glimmer made a disgusted noise.

"Why don't you just *talk* to her? She's not that scary, trust me."

"I can't," Adora said, despair coloring her tone. "I don't even know what I'd say."

"How about 'wanna see a movie sometime? Or let's get dinner together.' Anything is better than just staring at her like a creep."

"Also, you definitely earned some points saving her from that soccer ball the other day," Bow added. "Not to take credit or anything, but you're welcome."

Adora raised an eyebrow at him; he grinned in return.

"I can't," Adora said again, letting out a long, defeated sigh. "She's just... and I'm... it wouldn't work."

Bow and Glimmer exchanged looks, and sighed. Adora was great, and they were glad they had befriended her, but *man* was her self esteem low. She didn't seem to realize what a great catch she, even with a literal fan club following her around.

"You never know until you try," Bow pointed out. Adora looked at Catra again. Scorpia seemed to have wiped out; Catra was helping her get up, still chuckling. There was something so infectious about her smile, her laughter. Adora could feel a smile pulling at her lips just from watching the other woman.

No, she couldn't ask Catra out. But she could daydream a little, perhaps. That wasn't hurting anyone, right?

They made their way down to soccer practice, Glimmer still complaining about the C-minus she'd gotten after studying her ass

off for that test. Adora still wasn't really paying attention, but she thought she could be forgiven for that.

Practice came and went without much fuss. Glimmer wanted to keep going after the coach dismissed them, so she stuck Bow in the net and started doing practice shots. Adora lounged on the edge of the field, half watching them, half looking at her phone while she sipped her water. She opened Instagram, scrolling mindlessly until a recommended post came across her feed. The username was @[illegible], and the profile picture was definitely Scorpia. The picture she had posted was of Catra, asleep on a couch, a gray cat sleeping on her chest.

@[illegible] Meow sooooooooooomuch sadness!

Adora tapped on @[illegible], and there was Catra's page. It was mostly pictures of the same gray cat, interspersed with some skateboard photos. Adora scrolled, pausing on a selfie of Catra and Meow. She was so *cute*. Adora was glad no one was paying attention to her, or able to see the way her cheeks were turning red. She scrolled back up, thumb hovering over the *Follow* button. It was a public account. They went to school together. It wasn't that weird. Right?

"Oh my *god*," Glimmer declared loudly from right beside Adora. Adora jumped, but had no time to react any further before Glimmer grabbed her phone. "Pining from afar is a big lie, Adora. You'll thank me for this."

"Wait!"

Too late – Glimmer tapped the follow button and gave Adora her phone back.

"You're welcome!"

@[illegible] Processsending follow request

Catra stared at the notification in disbelief, then clicked on the profile picture. Yup, that was definitely Adora. Requesting to follow her on Instagram.

"Holy shit," she whispered. Melog jumped onto her desk and head-butted her furiously, clearly looking for attention. "Not now, buddy."

It wasn't a big deal. That was what she tried to tell herself as she accepted the request. Plenty of people she'd never spoken to followed her. This didn't *mean* anything.

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"Oh my god. That's *so* lame."

"*Hi*?" Adora rested the phone screen against her forehead, groaning. Why had she sent that? It was *sodumb*. It had seemed so funny in her head, but now that she saw it on the screen she might as well just get *Imabser* tattooed across her face.

Adora looked looked nervously at her phone. The typing bubble was at the bottom of the screen. Her heart jumped into her throat.

Hey, Adora

How's it going?

Sorry I haven't responded

forever.

Catra was blushing and trying not to laugh. She buried her face in her pillow, letting out what could only be classified as a giggle — although she would kill anyone who tried to identify it as such.

She hadn't expected Adora Gray to be such a *dork*. It was cute and endearing, to see the seemingly perfect woman being silly. Like it was a secret side of her.

But that was probably putting too much thought into it.

Adora and Catra had been talking for a few days now. It totally wasn't weird to ask her if she wanted to get coffee. That was what Catra reasoned anyway as she made breakfast and texted Adora asking if she wanted to hang out.

A sticker of a rainbow-maned unicorn saying [illegible] was definitely *not* the answer she had expected. A panicked flurry of texts followed.

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

How the hell did a unicorn even [illegible] a thumbs up?

“Stupid, stupid, stupid,” Adora muttered, hitting the heel of her palm against her forehead with each word. She was officially the lamest person in the world. She might as well just buy fifty cats and call it a lifetime. How was she supposed to date when she was *like this*?

Blessedly, Catra didn't retract the invitation; she just texted to arrange a time, and they exchanged some small talk. Adora breathed a little easier.

Most of their communication was still on the phone. They hung out together sometimes, but they were both pretty busy people, and free time was hard to come by.

But every now and again, Catra would make her way down to the soccer field and watch practice while she studied. Most of the time, she had to leave before practice was over. But Adora saw her there, and smiled that big, goofy smile — the one that stirred butterflies in Catra's stomach. That made it worth it.

She wasn't doing anything today, though, which meant she could stay until the end of practice, and maybe even hang out with Adora after. But that meant letting Adora's *fiancé* see them together. And even if it wasn't anything — and it probably wasn't anything, right? — they were still weird. Catra didn't want to cause trouble for herself or Adora.

But she also didn't want to hide parts of her life just to appease other people.

Adora bounded over to her as soon as the coach dismissed them. She hadn't even *changed* yet.

"Hey! Wanna get dinner with me, Bow, and Glimmer?"

Catra leaned slightly to the right to look across the field, where the club had huddled up. Yup, they were definitely giving her death

glares. "Sure." She was already committed. Might as well take it all the way.

Adora beamed. It was worth it.

"I can't *believe* you haven't asked her out yet!" Glimmer groaned, burying her face in her hands. "Do I have to do *everything* around here?"

Adora checked to make sure her phone was locked before she said anything. "No! I'm *going* to ask her out, I really am. I just... haven't found the right time."

"You guys talk literally every single day and see each other at least four times a week. When *exactly* is the right time?"

Adora had no idea, and that was the problem. She was waiting for some perfect moment – a thing that probably didn't exist. But it felt so anti-climatic to... what? Just ask her over coffee? Say, *Hey, date me?* No, she had to do it *right*. Which meant figuring out what *right* was.

"How did you ask Glimmer out?" she asked Bow, partially to distract Glimmer. That backfired, of course.

"Um, excuse me?" Glimmer said with a snort. "*I* asked *him* out, thank you very much."

Bow gave Adora a small, embarrassed smile. "I was going to ask her to prom. I made note cards and everything. But I dropped them right before lunch, and they were out of order, and it was all just kind of a mess."

"See, you guys think too much. That's the problem. Don't think. Just roll with it."

Don't think. Just roll with it. Somehow, Adora didn't think she could adjust to Glimmer's way of doing things.

Catra was going to do it. She was going to ask Adora to be her girlfriend.

She wasn't entirely sure if they had actually been on any official *dates*, yet. But they spent enough time together, and she certainly enjoyed it. And she was pretty sure Adora enjoyed it as well. Dating was the next natural step. Right?

Melog just stared at her when she said her reasoning out loud to him. What did he know? He was a cat.

Adora's weird fan club had relaxed slightly. Or at the very least, they no longer actively glared at Catra, which was nice. But Catra still got Looks if she passed any of them. And at least one of them usually managed to show up where they were. Today it was the same coffee shop they'd had their first hang out at. Adora was already waiting, fingers tangled together. She smiled when she saw Catra, and stood to pull out her chair.

"Hi!"

"What a gentleman," Catra teased, sitting. Adora blushed slightly, but she was smiling as she took her seat again.

"I ordered for you. I hope that's okay. You always get the same thing, so…"

Catra made a show of taking a critical sip of the coffee. "Hmm. It'll do."

Adora rolled her eyes. "You're ridiculous."

"But you keep hanging out with me."

"I guess I enjoy your company."

She *guessed*. Catra raised an eyebrow at her, taking another sip of her drink. Adora just smiled back innocently.

"Do you maybe want to see a movie after this?" Adora asked, sipping her drink. "Or we can go to that museum exhibit you were talking about the other day"…

Catra was impressed she remembered that. Adora was a fine student, but her eyes glazed over the minute Catra started talking about any extracurricular education. She hadn't been sure Adora had actually heard her talking about the museum.

"As much as I'd love to subject you to that horror, a movie is fine."

"Really, I think it'd be fun," Adora said. "With you, anyway."

"Aaawww, it almost sounds like you *like* me," Catra said, poking Adora's arm. "That's *so* embarrassing for you."

Adora shoved her hand away, smiling. "Or I *guess* I could see if Glimmer and Bow want to go to that exhibit"…

The idea was laughable at best. Bow would probably enjoy it ~~—he~~ was a bit of a history nerd ~~—~~ but Glimmer would fall asleep on every bench she could find. It was an empty threat.

"I will break up with you right now," Catra said in a deadpan voice. Something shifted in Adora's expression, and *oh*, Catra hadn't actually gotten to the asking out part yet. Well, that was awkward. I mean, um"…

She was suddenly very aware of the two girls sitting within earshot, listening intently.

"Um." Adora looked at her hands. Her fingers were hopelessly entangled.

"Forget I said that," Catra said quickly, her face burning. Damn it, she hadn't even managed to ask Adora out, and she had already ruined it. "That was stupid."

"Oh." Adora's voice was small. "Right. Of course."

They sat quietly, awkwardly, for a long moment. "It's just," Adora started to say in a rush, "I was going to ask you out after the movie or museum or whatever we ended up doing." Catra's heart jumped to her throat. "And obviously if you don't want that, that's okay! We can still hang out. I like spending time with you. If you want to spend time with me, I mean. If I've made it really weird, I understand."

Catra couldn't speak. She wanted to cheer and dance and kiss Adora and scream for the world to hear that Adora Gray was *her girlfriend*.

But none of that was happening, and Adora was starting to look very nervous. Catra finally forced her arm to move; her hand slid across the table, finding Adora's, and she laced their fingers together. Adora swallowed, looking at their hands, then at Catra.

"Really?" Catra nodded, and a slow smile spread across Adora's lips. "Okay. Cool. Wow."

"Don't ruin it."

Adora's fan club mostly adjusted to the new development. A few of them even grew to like the relationship. They dubbed the couple *Catdora*, and Adora finally found out the fan club existed.

"I don't get it. So, a bunch of girls just follow me around and admire me without me noticing?"

She was such an idiot. It was adorable. "Yes, Adora," Catra said patiently, trying not to roll her eyes. "Have you seriously never

noticed the same girls sitting near you at lunch and going to your soccer practices?"

"I just thought they were soccer fans!"

"Well, you weren't *entirely* wrong."

Adora shook her head, tugging Catra back to her. They were snuggling on the couch, watching a soccer game. Catra didn't get it, but it made her girlfriend happy. And it made *Catra* happy to think about Adora as her girlfriend. So they both won.

"But *how*?"

Now Catra *did* roll her eyes, pressing her finger to Adora's lips. "Sssssshhhh. Don't think too much about it."

"But—"

"*Sssh*."

They fell silent again. "Do… *you* have a fan club?" Adora asked after a moment.

"Just the ones from yours who've converted to *Catra*."

"That is *so* weird."

"Yup."

Back to the TV. "But why—"

Catra pushed herself up to kiss Adora, successfully distracting her. She would have laughed if she hadn't been busy.

"Should I stop talking about it?" Adora asked, lips moving against Catra's.

"Yes."

“Okay .”

End Notes

Like I said, pointless. Fluff y, sweet, tooth-rotting, and pointless. But review anyway? I don't write this kind of thing often, so I always worry about how it's going to do.

And my next planned fic is going to be so much angstier , I promise.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!